

If you have a low-risk application involving humans, complete the form below and email to your tutor for approval.

If you have a medium or high-risk application, you can use the form below to draft your answers before submitting using the [Taught Student Ethics Committee](#) google form. You may want to share a draft of your application with your tutor to discuss how you can improve it and save time before submitting the form.

Taught Student Ethics Application Form

If this is an application for a team project, for example on AcrossRCA, members of the team should develop it together. However, only one member should submit the application on behalf of the whole team and the remaining members should be identified within the application form.

You should only submit your Ethics application once you are able to answer each question in detail. Please note that if you do not provide sufficient information, the application will be referred back to you and this may delay the consideration of the outcome.

Student Name & Team Name (if working as part of a team)* : **Weijie Li**

Student ID Number*: **10066513**

Tutor's Name *: **Shannon Larkin**

Programme*: **MDes Design Futures**

School: **School of Design**

Please specify the unit on your programme which this application is being submitted for: **Independent Research Project**

Does your project require ethical approval from an external agency, such as the NHS, a partner institution or an employer? **No**

If yes, please specify who

Please provide a brief description of your project and the activities that it involves

This project investigates how alternative dietary feedback paradigms might reduce the Intention-Action Gap. The research involves qualitative semi-structured interviews (45-60 minutes) and a participatory critique session.

Low Risk: Does your project...* **yes**

- Involve human participants? **yes**
- Involve conflicts of interest between you and your participants? No
- Create outputs that identify individuals and/or organisations? No
- Involve the co-operation of a 'gatekeeper' to gain access to participants? No

Medium Risk: Does your project...*(**no**)

- Involve discussion of topics that participants may find distressing?
- Involve the offer of financial incentives to participants?
- Involve the collection of data without the informed consent of participants?
- Risk disclosing the physical and/or mental health of participants?
- Take place outside the UK?
- Involve the collection, use or storage of non-biological samples not already held in a university/museum collection?
- Involve the collection, use or storage of human tissue/DNA?
- Risk damaging the environment (beyond normal daily activity)?

High Risk: Does your project...*(**no**)

- Involve participants under 18 years of age?
- Involve participants who lack the capacity to consent?
- Involve medical research with humans?
- Involve the administration of drugs, placebos or other substances (e.g. food, vitamins) to humans?
- Risk causing physical and/or psychological harm to participants?
- Involve animal participants?

- Risk disturbing or damaging culturally, spiritually or historically significant artefacts/places/remains?
- Relate to the defence industry?
- Involve potentially illegal activities?

For any question where you have answered 'Yes' to above, please **explain how you will manage the ethical risks involved.**

The primary ethical consideration in this project relates to discussions around food, body image, and dietary tracking, which could potentially cause discomfort. To manage this risk and protect participants' wellbeing, I have implemented strict safeguards:

1. **Exclusion criteria:** Individuals with a current diagnosis of an eating disorder will be explicitly excluded from participating.
2. **Interview design:** The interview wording avoids moral language (e.g., "good/bad" foods) and weight-loss targets, focusing instead on descriptive reflection and 'Food Freedom'.
3. **Participant autonomy:** Participants will be fully briefed, can opt-out or withdraw at any point without reason, and all collected data will be anonymised and securely stored.

The project involves audio and video recording of interviews and participatory sessions to ensure accurate data capture for design analysis. To manage the associated privacy risks:

1. **Recording Consent:** Participants will provide explicit consent for each recording format (audio/video/photo) via the signed consent form.
2. **Anonymisation:** For project reports and presentations, any video or photographic data will be anonymised (e.g., blurring faces) unless the participant provides express written permission for their likeness to be shown.
3. **Secure Storage:** All large-scale media files (video/audio) will be stored on the **RCA Google Drive** to ensure encryption and limited access, and will be destroyed after analysis.
4. **Vulnerable Groups:** To protect wellbeing, individuals with a current diagnosis of an eating disorder are excluded

If your project involves human participants, please upload a Participant Information & Consent Form sheet (available on the RCA [Ethics on Taught Programmes page](#))